

WatchTower: User Personas



Alex
Software Engineer / Developer

Age 25 · Full-Stack Engineer at a Startup · Proficiency: Medium-High

"Fixing a bug is easy. Finding it is the hard part."

Fast-moving vibe coder who pushes code multiple times a week. Wants to ship features, not hunt through logs.



Goals

- Ship code quickly without breaking production
- Instantly pinpoint the exact file and error message
- Verify if a bug was introduced in the most recent push



Pain Points

- Context switching between multiple tools when errors hit
- Vague "site is slow" reports with zero context
- Non-specific "app is down" alerts with no actionable info



Key User Stories

- See which deployment caused an error spike
- Filter errors by severity & time window
- Toggle Real-time Stream mode on activity feed
- View network request timeline leading up to an error
- Set custom threshold alerts on specific routes



Sam
Engineering Manager / Team Lead

Age 35 · Tech Lead overseeing 4–6 developers · Proficiency: Very High

"I need one source of truth, not more noise on my phone."

Manages release pipeline and team health. Rarely codes. Focuses on SLAs, system health, and shielding team from burnout.



Goals

- Keep the system operational and minimize downtime
- High-level trustworthy system health indicator
- Be the objective source of truth when things go wrong



Pain Points

- Alert fatigue from noisy, low-priority warnings
- Mediating the blame game between Product and Engineering
- Learning about failures from angry Twitter users first



Key User Stories

- View system status banner (Operational / Degraded / Down)
- See summary of page loads, errors, and avg ratings
- Compare error rates between current vs previous deployment
- View latency timeline chart over last 24 hours



Taylor
Customer Support

Age 29 · Customer Support — Voice of the User · Proficiency: Low-to-Medium

"I need to prove to engineering the problem is real and widespread."

Handles user complaints and escalations. Cannot read code. Needs visual, intuitive dashboards to prove issues are real.



Goals

- Identify patterns in user complaints quickly
- Know if an issue is isolated or systemic
- Give users accurate updates when incidents occur



Pain Points

- Users submit vague tickets with no technical context
- No visibility into when engineering pushes new code
- Constantly pinging devs on Slack just to ask "is it down?"



Key User Stories

- Correlate low ratings with specific backend error codes
- Search feedback logs by keywords or email
- View browser/OS context attached to feedback entries
- See ratings side-by-side with click event volumes

WatchTower:User Stories

Developer (Alex)

9 stories

1

As a developer, I want to...
See which deployment is associated with a spike in errors so I can know if my recent code push broke production.

2

As a developer, I want to...
Filter errors by severity and recent time windows to focus only on the most urgent problems affecting users right now.

3

As a developer, I want to...
See page loads and clicks grouped by path to identify which specific routes are experiencing issues.

4

As a developer, I want to...
Copy a direct link to a detailed error trace to share with teammates on Slack for instant collaboration.

5

As a developer, I want to...
Toggle a "Real-time Stream" mode to watch incoming events stream in without manually refreshing.

6

As a developer, I want to...
Filter telemetry by environment (dev, staging, production) to prevent local errors from skewing production metrics.

7

As a developer, I want to...
See a timeline of network requests and status codes leading up to an error to check for backend API failures.

8

As a developer, I want to...
View the sequence of user click events before a client-side error was thrown to reproduce the crash.

9

As a developer, I want to...
Set custom threshold alerts on specific routes to be notified when error rates exceed my tolerance.

Team Lead (Sam)

5 stories

10

As a team lead, I want to...
View a high-level system status banner (Operational, Degraded, Down) to quickly decide whether a rollback is needed.

11

As a team lead, I want to...
See a summary count of page loads, errors, and average ratings to gauge overall application health at a glance.

12

As a team lead, I want to...
See an aggregated "Recent Activity" feed of all signal types to understand the sequence of events before a degradation.

13

As a team lead, I want to...
View a timeline chart of application latency over the last 24 hours to identify response degradation after a deployment.

14

As a team lead, I want to...
Compare error rates and average ratings between the current and previous deployment to measure quality over time.

Customer Support (Taylor)

5 stories

15

As a support agent, I want to...
Correlate low user feedback ratings with specific backend error codes to write actionable bug reports for engineering.

16

As a support agent, I want to...
View an aggregated average rating from user surveys to understand how recent changes have impacted user experience.

17

As a support agent, I want to...
Search user feedback logs by keywords or email addresses to verify if a user's issue has already been captured.

18

As a support agent, I want to...
See user feedback ratings and comments side-by-side with click event volumes to assess user engagement.

19

As a support agent, I want to...
See browser type, OS, and client-side context attached to user feedback entries to pass complete details to developers.

Accessibility

6 stories

20

As a user, I want to...
Toggle a colorblind-friendly theme (deutanopia/protanopia safe) to distinguish success, warning, and error states.

21

As a user, I want to...
Dashboard supports up to 200% text zoom with high contrast ratios so I can comfortably read logs and metrics.

22

As a user, I want to...
All animations and transitions respect the prefers-reduced-motion media query so I can use the dashboard safely.

23

As a user, I want to...
System status and error alerts are announced through ARIA live regions so I can monitor health without visual dashboards.

24

As a user, I want to...
Filtering controls are simple and easy to understand so I can start investigating issues without extra training.

25

As a user, I want to...
Clear, high-visibility focus rings on all interactive elements so I can navigate the dashboard with keyboard only.